**W** Waterline

Private preview · Operating in stealth

# Turn performing loans into dependable funding.

Credit infrastructure that lets Nigerian lenders access institutional capital against their own loan books — without giving up equity.

Company overview — for discussion purposes
Lagos, Nigeria · 2026

THE PROBLEM

## Nigerian lenders sit on good assets they can't fund cheaply

# — and investors want the yield but can't verify the book.

LENDER SIDE

### Banks, MFBs, fintechs and leasing companies

- **Funding is short-term and expensive** — deposits and short lines don't match the tenor of the loans they've already written.
- **Institutional capital is out of reach** — raising a bond, forward-flow or securitization needs a data room most lenders can't produce on their own.
- **Every structuring conversation starts from zero** — no shared data format, no reusable diligence trail, no comparable to point to.

INVESTOR SIDE

### Institutional investors and DFIs seeking Nigerian credit yield

- **No standardized loan tape to underwrite against** — every lender's export is a different shape, in a different currency of trust.
- **No independent portfolio context** — assessing one lender's book means building institution-level comparables from scratch, deal by deal.
- **Structuring is bespoke and slow** — eligibility screening, tranching and cashflow modelling get rebuilt for every pool.

WHY NOW

# The lending market has grown faster than the infrastructure that funds it.

01

### A bigger, more diverse lending base

Digital lenders, MFBs and leasing/asset-finance companies have originated at scale over the last decade, alongside the traditional banks — most of it funded on-balance-sheet.

02

### Off-balance-sheet funding is now the constraint

Growth is capped less by origination capability and more by the ability to move performing loans off-balance-sheet into structures institutional capital will actually buy.

03

### No shared credit-data standard exists locally

Unlike more developed securitization markets, there is no common loan-data format or standardized validation layer that a Nigerian lender's tape can be checked against before it reaches an investor.

04

### Deal teams still work like it's diligence-by-PDF

Sourcing, benchmarking and structuring still run on scraped filings, static pitch decks and one-off spreadsheet models — rebuilt fresh for every transaction.

THE SOLUTION

# Waterline

Waterline is **credit infrastructure** for Nigerian lenders — the data standard, market intelligence and deal-structuring layer that turns a performing loan book into a pool institutional capital can underwrite.

01

### Market Intelligence

Institution and portfolio-level data — NPL ratios, ratings, capital-markets activity — sourced from public filings, so sourcing and benchmarking start from evidence, not a pitch.

SOURCING & BENCHMARKING

02

### Data Standard (WCDS)

A canonical loan-data schema and deterministic validation rulebook that maps a lender's raw tape into a clean, audit-ready loan book investors can actually underwrite.

STANDARDIZATION

03

### SPV Structuring

Eligibility screening, Senior/Mezzanine/Equity tranche sizing and a cashflow waterfall simulation that turns a validated pool into a structured, investable transaction.

DEAL EXECUTION

HOW IT WORKS

## One workflow, from a raw loan tape to a closed, funded structure.

1

### Discovery

Lender shares a loan tape under NDA; Waterline reviews portfolio quality against market context from Tier 1 data.

2

### Structure

The tape is mapped and canonicalized against the Waterline Credit Data Standard (WCDS) into a clean, comparable loan book.

3

### Validate

The book runs through a 30-rule validation and reconciliation engine; eligible facilities are screened and tranches sized.

4

### Close

A cashflow waterfall is modelled across tranches and the structure is placed with investors — with investor-grade reporting throughout.

— PRODUCT — DATA STANDARD

## The Waterline Credit Data Standard (WCDS)

Every lender's export looks different. WCDS gives them one canonical shape — and a deterministic rulebook that catches the errors that would otherwise surface mid-deal.

18

**Canonical entities**

Facility, FacilitySnapshot, Party, Collateral, Payment, Schedule, CreditRisk and more — a full loan data model, not a flat spreadsheet.

30

**Deterministic validation rules**

Every tape is checked against the same 30-rule rulebook — no silent gaps, no "trust me" fields.

→

**Map → canonicalize → validate → reconcile**

Raw CSV/XLSX in; a clean, control-totalled, audit-ready loan book out.

**Validation summary** Reconciled

| | |
|---|---|
| Control totals | Matched |
| Facility status consistency | Pass |
| Currency & unit consistency | Pass |
| DPD / arrears logic | Pass |
| Concentration limits | Flagged — 2 |
| Deep entities | Skipped |

— PRODUCT — DEAL STRUCTURING

# SPV structuring & cashflow waterfall

Once a book is clean, Waterline turns it into a structure — the same eligibility, sizing and cashflow logic an arranger would build by hand, run consistently every time.

1. **Eligibility screening**
   Status, days-past-due, default, currency, tenor and concentration limits applied against configurable deal criteria.
2. **Tranche sizing**
   Senior, Mezzanine and Equity tranches sized off the eligible pool.
3. **Waterfall simulation**
   Monthly cashflow modelling with sequential-pay allocation and stress overlays, so the structure can be pressure-tested before a term sheet.

**Illustrative pool**

₦1.0bn pool

| | |
|---|---|
| SENIOR | ₦750m |
| MEZZ | ₦150m |
| EQUITY | ₦100m |

| | |
|---|---|
| Weighted average yield | **27.8%** |
| Indicative senior capacity | **₦750m** |
| Investor reporting readiness | **Ready** |

PRODUCT — MARKET INTELLIGENCE

# A portfolio readiness view, backed by evidence — not a pitch.

Every figure traces back to a source document via a provenance record, so it survives an investor's "where did this number come from?"

**Portfolio readiness**

Illustrative pool assessment

Review complete

**₦1.0bn**
Eligible balance

**4,281**
Facilities

**92.4%**
Completeness

| | |
|---|---|
| Portfolio quality | **Within policy** |
| Weighted average yield | **27.8%** |
| Senior capacity | **₦750m** |
| Reporting readiness | **Ready** |

BUSINESS MODEL

# Waterline is paid for infrastructure and execution — not for holding credit risk.

Waterline never takes the loans onto its own balance sheet. It is the standardization, intelligence and structuring layer that sits between a lender's book and the capital that funds it.

STANDARDIZATION

### WCDS engagements

Lenders and technical partners engage Waterline directly to standardize a loan book against WCDS — an independent, fee-based service, ahead of and outside of any funding deal.

DEAL EXECUTION

### Structuring & placement

Origination and structuring fees on securitization / forward-flow transactions — screening, tranching, waterfall modelling and investor placement for a validated pool.

ONGOING INFRASTRUCTURE

### Data & reporting

Recurring fees for investor reporting, portfolio monitoring and market-intelligence access across the life of a structure.

WHY WATERLINE

## Infrastructure, not another balance sheet.

**01**

### A real data standard, not a spreadsheet template

WCDS is a full canonical schema with a deterministic rulebook — built and tested end-to-end against synthetic loan tapes before it ever touches a real one.

**02**

### Intelligence and execution in one workflow

Market intelligence, standardization and structuring live on one platform — most incumbents offer one of the three, requiring a lender to stitch the rest together.

03

### Founding team from both sides of the table

Banking, ratings and central-banking experience across Nigerian and international institutions — the team has sat inside the institutions it now serves.

04

### Neutral by design

Waterline doesn't originate or hold loans, so its incentives are aligned with getting the data and the structure right — not with maximizing its own book.

WHERE WE ARE

## The platform is built. We're in private preview with a small group of lenders and investors.

✓ **WCDS v0.1 published**

Full canonical schema, field dictionary and 30-rule validation rulebook, specified and documented.

✓ **Ingestion pipeline live**

Mapper, canonicalizer, validator and reconciler built and tested end-to-end against synthetic loan tapes.

✓ **SPV structuring engine live**

Eligibility screening, tranche sizing and cashflow waterfall simulation, exposed via API.

✓ **Market intelligence database live**

Institution and portfolio-level schema, seeded from public filings and rating actions.

**Currently in stealth.** Waterline is operating a private preview with a small group of Nigerian lenders, institutional investors and transaction partners while the platform is pressure-tested ahead of a public launch.

TEAM

# Founders who have sat on both sides of a credit transaction.

## Richard Awe

CO-FOUNDER

Financial-services and technology leader with experience across banking, central banking, government, ratings and software delivery.

Access Bank · Barclays Bank · HSBC · Lloyds Banking Group · European Central Bank · HMRC · 3d7 Technologies · Fitch Ratings

### Abiodun Awe

**CO-FOUNDER**

Markets-infrastructure and issuer-services specialist with experience across central banking, investment banking, custody and ratings.

Central Bank of Nigeria · Morgan Stanley · NatWest Markets · BBC · Co-op · Equiniti · BNY · Fitch Ratings

VISION

# The standard layer for African credit markets.

Start as the **data and structuring infrastructure** for Nigerian lenders — become the layer every credit transaction on the continent gets checked against.

NOW

**Nigeria, term loans & leases**

Deepen coverage across banks, MFBs, fintechs and leasing companies.

NEXT

**More asset classes**

Extend WCDS and structuring to trade finance, invoice discounting and consumer credit.

LATER

### Pan-African coverage

Take the standard and the structuring workflow to other African credit markets facing the same funding gap.

W Waterline

# We'd like to talk.

Waterline is in private preview and not currently running a funding process — but we're always glad to compare notes with investors and partners who work in Nigerian credit markets.

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Request private preview access